

LOCAL TEST 2 • FROZEN WALDRON SCENARIO

Meridian Arts Collective – Scope of Work Agent Conversation

Complete Project Management Gate Transcript

Verbatim transcript from the first Gate 1 question through the completed Gate 6 evaluation.
Chronological order preserved, including corrections, revisions, and formal gate feedback.

Prepared August 18, 2026

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Check-in and Gate 1 - Big 5 Pre-Planning

EXCHANGE 01

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Local Test 2 is active for the frozen "Allocating the Waldron" scenario. This run uses no Actions or telemetry, makes no external writes, and cannot affect a Canvas grade. Nothing from this test will be formally logged. Please avoid personal, medical, financial, authentication, or other sensitive information.

Gate 1: Big 5 Pre-Planning

The Big 5 help you assess the project manager's position before planning. We'll work in Guided mode, one question at a time, and preserve your fragments. Formal evaluation occurs only when you explicitly say `Submit Gate 1`.

What you will produce:

- Five short Big 5 answers
- The existing study Marcus should examine and why
- One lesson from the provided comparison example

Part A — Position

Progress: Gate 1 initiated; no answers assembled yet.

Next: What does Meridian's history—the integration plan, late website consolidation, or abandoned donor-database merge—suggest about its ability to plan and execute projects?

MY RESPONSE

Meridian can plan on paper (the consultant delivered a 214-page plan) but struggles to execute internally — the facilities/programming sections of that plan stalled, the website project ran four months late, and the donor database merge was simply abandoned with no documented reason. That history suggests weak in-house project discipline and a real risk that the Waldron allocation project also stalls or gets quietly dropped if it isn't tightly scoped and tracked.

EXCHANGE 02

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

That clearly connects Meridian's planning history to a likely recurrence: strong planning documents but weak internal execution.

Progress: Part A Q1 is preserved.

Next: What is Marcus's role in this project, and what remains unclear about that role?

MY RESPONSE

Marcus is Director of Operations and, per Dana's email, will "lead the process" for the Waldron allocation project — he controls the meeting schedule, who's consulted, the format of the final recommendation, and the \$35,000 budget. What's unclear: his authority is only stated in an email (nothing formal or announced to staff), and no one — including Marcus — has been assigned responsibility for managing fallout with unhappy legacy leads or for communicating with the City.

EXCHANGE 03

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've defined Marcus's operational control and the important gaps in his formal authority and political support.

Progress: Part A Q1 and Q2 are preserved.

Next: How much “juice”—authority, influence, time, and support—does Marcus have, and where are its limits?

MY RESPONSE

Marcus has real but narrow authority: he controls the process (meetings, consultation, recommendation format) and the \$35,000 budget, but not the final allocation decision, the legacy leads' participation, the season calendar, or the lease. His time is thin — only 0.4 FTE, split with front-of-house, rentals, and building maintenance — and his team totals just 0.75 FTE combined, with no formal mandate communicated to staff and no backing to referee conflicts between the legacy leads.

EXCHANGE 04

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've distinguished Marcus's process authority from the decisions he cannot control, while accounting for limited capacity and weak organizational backing. Part A is complete.

Progress: Q1–Q3 are preserved. Part B covers support and plan type.

A patron is a well-positioned person who can provide inside knowledge, early warning, access, and protection when resistance arises.

Next: Who should Marcus choose as his patron, and what specific support would that person provide?

MY RESPONSE

Dana Okoye, the Executive Director — she's the only person with authority over all three legacy artistic leads. As patron, she should formalize Marcus's mandate in writing and announce it to staff (closing the "nothing in writing" gap), and lend her authority to compel the legacy leads' participation and cooperation, even though she's already said she won't personally referee disputes between them.

EXCHANGE 05

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've made a defensible patron choice and identified both Dana's potential support and her stated limit: she can formalize Marcus's mandate, but she will not referee among the legacy leads.

Progress: Q1–Q4 are preserved.

Next: What kind of plan should this be—a one-time allocation, a standing policy, or a scheduling system—and why does that form fit Meridian's situation?

MY RESPONSE

A standing policy/scheduling framework, not a one-time carve-up — because the competing demands aren't static: Mainstage only needs the Ruth/Firebay during tech weeks, New Play wants Firebay availability recurring for workshops, and Learning & Media needs a fixed weekly schedule, all layered against existing multi-year commitments (dance school through 2028, gallery booked 14 months out) and the 900-hour community-access requirement Meridian must keep meeting every year. The budget even includes room-scheduling software, signaling this needs to be an ongoing allocation system the board approves once, not a single permanent room assignment that would have to be re-fought every season.

EXCHANGE 06

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've selected an ongoing framework and connected it to recurring program demands, existing commitments, annual access obligations, and the available scheduling-software budget. Part B is complete.

Progress: Q1–Q5 are preserved. Part C is the evidence check.

Provided comparison example: Oakwood Smart Transit

A city hired a software company to build real-time bus tracking and digital payment under a broad promise to create a user-friendly transit system. The course case examines possible scope gaps, miscommunication, and pressure on time, cost, or quality.

Like Meridian's project, it coordinates a shared public service for multiple users. It highlights:

- The difference between a broad service promise and specific operating rules
- User-access and coordination assumptions hidden by vague scope
- End-state checks that should be defined before implementation

Adapted course case—use for comparison, not as factual evidence about Meridian. No outside research or citation checking is required.

Next: What existing study should Marcus examine, and why could it help with the allocation plan?

MY RESPONSE

The 2019 space utilization study sitting unread in the admin suite filing cabinet — it has floor plans, room dimensions, and a full year of actual booking data, which could give Marcus real usage patterns to base allocation decisions on instead of starting from scratch or relying only on each legacy group's stated wishes.

EXCHANGE 07

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've identified the unread 2019 space-utilization study and explained how its physical and booking data could ground the plan in evidence rather than competing preferences.

Progress: All five Big 5 answers and the internal-study portion are preserved. One Part C item remains.

Next: From the Oakwood Smart Transit example, what is one practice Meridian could examine or adapt, and why would it help?

MY RESPONSE

Meridian could adapt Oakwood's practice of defining clear, specific operating rules instead of a broad promise — rather than promising a vaguely "fair" allocation, the plan should spell out concrete rules (who gets which space, when, and under what priority) so it doesn't hide unresolved coordination assumptions the way Oakwood's "user-friendly transit system" promise did. This would also mean defining end-state checks up front — like confirming the plan actually hits the 900 community-access hours — before the board votes, rather than discovering gaps after implementation.

EXCHANGE 08

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've drawn a clear lesson from the comparison: replace a broad promise with explicit operating rules and define checks before implementation.

Progress: Your Gate 1 working draft now includes all five Big 5 answers, the unread 2019 study and its value, and one explained lesson from the provided comparison example.

Next: Would you like formal evaluation now? If so, say Submit Gate 1.

MY RESPONSE

Submit Gate 1.

EXCHANGE 09

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Gate: 1 — Big 5 Pre-Planning

Progress: 6 of 6 required items passed. Your five Big 5 answers are complete; they use Meridian's planning history, respect Marcus's authority limits, identify the unread 2019 study, and explain a relevant lesson from the single provided comparison example.

What still needs attention: Nothing blocking.

Ready to move on: YES — Gate OPEN

Optional advice: This advice does not block you. Because Dana has refused to referee among the legacy leads, later planning should distinguish the support she can provide from conflict management she will not provide.

Your next move: Say *Begin Gate 2* when you are ready to start Requirements.

MY RESPONSE

Begin Gate 2

Gate 2 - Requirements

EXCHANGE 10

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Gate 2: Requirements

Requirements are necessary conditions the allocation plan must satisfy—not preferred solutions. For each requirement, you'll identify its authority, type, how compliance would be verified, and whether it is confirmed by the course scenario or needs verification from the appropriate authority. Fragments are welcome; formal evaluation waits for *Submit Gate 2*.

What you will produce:

- Community-access requirement and current gap
- Dance-school commitment
- Contracted gallery calendar
- Accessibility and safety constraints
- No capital work or lease change
- Source, type, verification method, and status for every entry

Progress: Gate 1 is preserved; Gate 2 drafting has begun.

Next: What requirement does the City lease create for community access, and what is Meridian's documented current position?

MY RESPONSE

- **Requirement:** The City lease requires 900 hours/year of community access to the Waldron at below-market rates.
- **Current position:** Meridian currently documents only 515 hours — a 385-hour gap.
- **Source/Authority:** The City lease (external, legal).
- **Type:** Mandatory/compliance constraint, not a preference.
- **Verification method:** Audited by Gwen Tsai, the City Arts Commission liaison, who administers the lease and decides how strictly the requirement is checked.

- **Status:** Confirmed by the scenario — both the 900-hour requirement and the 515-hour current figure are stated directly.

EXCHANGE 11**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

You've captured the 900-hour requirement, the documented 515 hours, the 385-hour gap, its lease authority, and Gwen's audit role.

The course uses fixed labels for two fields:

- **Type:** legal/regulatory, contractual, client, operational, accessibility/safety, or other with an explanation
- **Status:** CONFIRMED or VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY

Progress: The community-access entry is preserved; its Type and Status labels need alignment.

Next: Revise only those two labels using one allowed value for each.

MY RESPONSE

- **Type:** legal/regulatory (it's a lease condition tied to the City's community-access requirement, imposed by an external governing party)
- **Status:** CONFIRMED (both the 900-hour requirement and the 515-hour current figure are stated directly in the scenario)

EXCHANGE 12**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Those labels now match the required format, and your explanations support both choices.

Progress: The community-access requirement is complete and preserved.

Next: Draft the dance-school requirement with its source or authority, type, verification method or evidence, and status.

MY RESPONSE

- **Requirement:** Studios C and D must remain reserved for the dance school every Tuesday and Thursday, 4–8 p.m., through August 2028 — the allocation plan cannot reassign that space/time.
- **Source/Authority:** The dance school's signed agreement with Meridian.
- **Type:** contractual
- **Verification method/evidence:** Review the written agreement to confirm the exact rooms, days, hours, and end date.
- **Status:** CONFIRMED (the scenario states the agreement, rooms, schedule, and end date directly).

EXCHANGE 13**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

You've framed the dance-school commitment as a binding contractual condition and included a specific documentary check.

Progress: The community-access and dance-school requirements are complete and preserved.

Next: Draft the requirement created by the Main Gallery calendar, including the same four supporting fields.

MY RESPONSE

- **Requirement:** The Main Gallery's exhibition calendar is contracted 14 months out, so the allocation plan cannot reassign or repurpose the Main Gallery within that contracted window.
- **Source/Authority:** Existing contracts with visual artists for scheduled exhibitions.
- **Type:** contractual
- **Verification method/evidence:** Review the artist exhibition contracts/calendar to confirm which dates and how far out (14 months) are locked in.
- **Status:** CONFIRMED (the scenario states the 14-month contracted calendar directly).

EXCHANGE 14

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've captured the fourteen-month contracted window, its contract authority, and a concrete verification method.

Progress: Three requirements are complete and preserved: community access, dance school, and gallery calendar.

Next: Draft the requirement for fire-code occupancy limits and ADA access, while keeping it within the project's no-capital boundary. Include the same four supporting fields.

MY RESPONSE

- **Requirement:** Any room reassignment or schedule change must stay within existing fire-code occupancy limits and existing ADA access provisions for each space — and since there's no capital budget, the plan cannot propose renovations, added exits, or accessibility retrofits to accommodate new uses.
- **Source/Authority:** Local fire code/fire marshal and the federal ADA.
- **Type:** accessibility/safety
- **Verification method/evidence:** Check existing occupancy certificates/fire-code limits per room and current ADA compliance status for each space before assigning new uses; confirm with the fire marshal or facilities records since exact numbers aren't in the scenario.
- **Status:** CONFIRMED that the constraint applies (stated directly in the scenario); the specific occupancy numbers and ADA compliance details per room are VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY.

EXCHANGE 15

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've kept the safety and accessibility requirement inside the no-capital boundary and identified that the scenario confirms applicability but not room-level details.

Each listed requirement needs one unambiguous status. When a statement combines confirmed course facts with details needing external confirmation, separate them or narrow the statement.

Progress: The requirement's substance, type, authority, and verification approach are preserved; its status structure needs clarification.

Next: Revise this entry so each requirement has exactly one status: either CONFIRMED or VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY.

MY RESPONSE

- **Requirement A:** Fire-code occupancy and ADA access rules apply to all Waldron spaces, and the allocation plan cannot propose capital work (renovations, added exits, retrofits) to meet them.
- **Source/Authority:** Local fire code and the federal ADA.
- **Type:** accessibility/safety
- **Verification:** Stated directly as a constraint in the scenario.

- Status: CONFIRMED
- **Requirement B:** The specific occupancy limits and ADA compliance status for each individual room (Ruth, Firebay, galleries, studios, etc.).
- Source/Authority: Fire marshal's occupancy certificates and building ADA records.
- Type: accessibility/safety
- Verification: Pull existing occupancy certificates and ADA compliance documentation per room.
- Status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY

EXCHANGE 16**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Separating the scenario-confirmed constraint from the room-level facts needing authority verification makes both statuses unambiguous. Your no-capital boundary is also preserved, and none of your requirements assumes a lease change.

Progress: Your Gate 2 draft now covers the community-access gap, dance-school agreement, gallery calendar, fire-code and ADA constraints, sources, types, verification methods, and statuses.

Next: Would you like formal evaluation now? If so, say *Submit Gate 2*.

MY RESPONSE

Submit Gate 2

EXCHANGE 17**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Gate: 2 — Requirements

Progress: 8 of 8 required items passed. Your work covers the 900-hour community-access requirement and 385-hour gap, the dance-school agreement through August 2028, the fourteen-month gallery calendar, and the fire-code and ADA constraints. Every listed requirement includes a source, allowed type, verification method or evidence, and valid status.

What still needs attention: Nothing blocking.

Ready to move on: YES — Gate OPEN

Optional advice: This advice does not block you. Requirement B could later be phrased as a condition to be satisfied, rather than only naming the information that must be collected.

Connection to your earlier work: Your answers connect.

Your next move: Say *Begin Gate 3* when you are ready to start Expectations.

MY RESPONSE

Begin Gate 3

Gate 3 - Expectations / MoSCoW

EXCHANGE 18**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Gate 3: Expectations

Expectations are hoped-for, assumed, or unstated outcomes—not binding requirements. You'll organize them using MoSCoW: Must, Should, Could, and Won't. Every item needs a source tag of requirement, expectation, or preference. Fixed project boundaries belong in Won't; competing expectations should remain visible rather than being prematurely reconciled.

What you will produce:

- A non-empty Won't category
- Five fixed project boundaries as distinct Won't entries
- The Firebay conflict by program area
- A source tag for every item
- No duplicate item across categories
- Your own justified MoSCoW choices

Progress: Gates 1 and 2 are preserved; Gate 3 drafting has begun.

Next: What competing expectations do New Play Development and Mainstage have for the Firebay?

MY RESPONSE

- **New Play Development:** wants the Firebay black box available year-round for its workshops (source tag: expectation).
- **Mainstage:** wants the Ruth plus the Firebay reserved for rehearsal during tech weeks (source tag: expectation).

These conflict because both want priority claim on the same room, just on different timing logic — one wants standing year-round access, the other wants concentrated blocks during tech weeks — so the allocation plan has to reconcile competing use patterns on a single shared space rather than assume both can simply coexist untouched.

EXCHANGE 19

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've identified both program areas, their incompatible timing demands, and why the conflict cannot be treated as automatically resolved.

Progress: The Firebay conflict and both source tags are preserved.

Next: Which MoSCoW category would you assign to each Firebay expectation, and why? Keep each item in only one category.

MY RESPONSE

- **Mainstage's Firebay+Ruth need during tech weeks — Should.** It's tied to producing the existing five-show subscription season on fixed dates (September–May), which is Meridian's core, already-committed program. It isn't a binding requirement (no lease/contract forces it), but failing to accommodate it risks a real production, so it ranks higher than a general preference.
- **New Play Development's year-round Firebay availability — Could.** It's a standing, ongoing wish rather than tied to a specific fixed date or existing commitment — workshops could be scheduled around other priorities without threatening a dated deliverable, making it desirable but more deferrable.

EXCHANGE 20

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've made distinct MoSCoW choices and justified them against program commitments and scheduling flexibility without treating either expectation as a binding requirement.

Progress: The Firebay conflict is preserved in Should and Could, with no duplication.

Next: Draft the `Won't` category using all five fixed scenario exclusions as five separate entries. Preserve each exclusion's stable ID and meaning, and tag every one `requirement`.

MY RESPONSE

Won't (Out of Scope) — all tagged `requirement`:

1. **W1 — No renovation, construction, or capital campaign.** The project works only within the existing physical building.
2. **W2 — No staff restructuring or layoffs.** Personnel structure is not part of this allocation decision.
3. **W3 — No merging the three legacy ticketing systems.** Ticketing integration is a separate, unaddressed effort.
4. **W4 — No renegotiating the City lease.** Lease terms (including the 900-hour requirement) are fixed inputs, not negotiable within this project.
5. **W5 — No choosing the 2027–28 season's shows.** Programming content decisions belong to programming staff, not this allocation process.

EXCHANGE 21

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

The five meanings, separate entries, `Won't` placement, and `requirement` tags are correct. The labels `W1–W5`, however, are newly created labels rather than the stable scenario IDs.

Progress: All five `Won't` meanings are preserved; only their IDs need correction.

Next: Replace `W1–W5` with the five exact `EX-...` IDs from the frozen scenario, without changing your descriptions.

MY RESPONSE

Won't (Out of Scope) — all tagged `requirement`:

1. **EX-1 — No renovation, construction, or capital campaign.** The project works only within the existing physical building.
2. **EX-2 — No staff restructuring or layoffs.** Personnel structure is not part of this allocation decision.
3. **EX-3 — No merging the three legacy ticketing systems.** Ticketing integration is a separate, unaddressed effort.
4. **EX-4 — No renegotiating the City lease.** Lease terms (including the 900-hour requirement) are fixed inputs, not negotiable within this project.
5. **EX-5 — No choosing the 2027–28 season's shows.** Programming content decisions belong to programming staff, not this allocation process.

EXCHANGE 22

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Your meanings remain correct, but `EX-1` through `EX-5` still abbreviate the required IDs. The exact fixed IDs are:

1. `EX-01_CAPITAL_WORK`
2. `EX-02_STAFF_RESTRUCTURING`
3. `EX-03_TICKETING_MERGE`
4. `EX-04_LEASE_RENEGOTIATION`
5. `EX-05_SEASON_SELECTION`

Progress: The five entries, meanings, placement, and tags are preserved.

Next: Replace only the abbreviated labels with these exact IDs in the corresponding order.

MY RESPONSE

Won't (Out of Scope) — all tagged requirement:

1. **EX-01_CAPITAL_WORK — No renovation, construction, or capital campaign.** The project works only within the existing physical building.
2. **EX-02_STAFF_RESTRUCTURING — No staff restructuring or layoffs.** Personnel structure is not part of this allocation decision.
3. **EX-03_TICKETING_MERGE — No merging the three legacy ticketing systems.** Ticketing integration is a separate, unaddressed effort.
4. **EX-04_LEASE_RENEGOTIATION — No renegotiating the City lease.** Lease terms (including the 900-hour requirement) are fixed inputs, not negotiable within this project.
5. **EX-05_SEASON_SELECTION — No choosing the 2027–28 season's shows.** Programming content decisions belong to programming staff, not this allocation process.

EXCHANGE 23

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

The five stable IDs now match their fixed meanings, remain separate in Won't, and carry the required source tag.

Progress: Your Gate 3 draft includes a non-empty Won't category with all five fixed exclusions, the visible Firebay conflict, distinct Should and Could placements, source tags for every item, and no duplicated entries.

Next: Would you like formal evaluation now? If so, say `Submit Gate 3`.

MY RESPONSE

`Submit Gate 3`

EXCHANGE 24

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Gate: 3 — Expectations

Progress: 5 of 5 required items passed. Your Won't category contains all five fixed exclusions as distinct entries with exact IDs, meanings, and requirement tags. The Firebay conflict remains visible by program area, all MoSCoW items have source tags, and no item is duplicated across categories.

What still needs attention: Nothing blocking.

Ready to move on: YES — Gate OPEN

Optional advice: This advice does not block you. You could later identify Marcus's own expectations for the process, separate from the program-area expectations.

Connection to your earlier work: Your exclusions align with Gate 2's no-capital and no-lease-change boundaries, while your Firebay choices remain expectations rather than being presented as requirements.

Your next move: Say `Begin Gate 4` when you are ready to start Goals & Objectives.

MY RESPONSE

`Begin Gate 4`

Gate 4 - Goals & Objectives

EXCHANGE 25

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**Gate 4: Goals & Objectives**

A goal describes the project's direction without a fixed measurement. Objectives are specific checkpoints that can be answered yes or no using a number, date, or count. You'll create one goal and three to five measurable objectives tied to the frozen timeline.

What you will produce:

- Exactly one directional goal
- Three to five measurable objectives
- A number, date, or count in every objective
- May 14 as a fixed point
- No objective completed after June 1
- Tangible evidence showing when each objective is achieved

Progress: Gates 1–3 are preserved; Gate 4 drafting has begun.

Next: What single directional goal should guide the Waldron allocation project?

MY RESPONSE

Goal: Develop a fair, sustainable space-allocation framework for the Waldron Arts Center that balances the three legacy programs' needs, honors existing outside commitments, and meets the City's community-access requirement — enabling the board to approve it and programming to plan the next season with confidence.

EXCHANGE 26**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your goal is directional and connects balanced program needs, outside commitments, community access, board approval, and the season-planning handoff without turning the goal itself into a measurement.

Progress: The single Gate 4 goal is preserved.

Next: What measurable objective should the project complete for the Board Facilities Committee's March 19 progress update? Include a number, date, or count.

MY RESPONSE

Objective: Present a draft allocation option (or set of options) covering all 12 Waldron spaces, plus a documented plan to close the 385-hour community-access gap (515 □ 900 hours), to the Board Facilities Committee by March 19.

EXCHANGE 27**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

This objective has a clear deadline, covers all 12 identified spaces, and makes the community-access gap measurable.

Progress: The goal and first objective are preserved.

Next: What measurable objective should be achieved by the board's May 14 fixed point?

MY RESPONSE

Objective: By May 14, the Board of Directors votes to approve one final Waldron allocation plan that closes the 385-hour community-access gap (515 □ 900 hours) and stays within the \$35,000 facilities-planning budget.

EXCHANGE 28

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

This objective uses May 14 as the fixed point and includes measurable approval, access, and budget conditions. Board approval depends on a decision outside Marcus's control, which can be revisited as optional refinement.

Progress: The goal and two measurable objectives are preserved.

Next: What third objective should cover the post-vote handoff to programming before the June 1 season announcement? Include a number, date, or count.

MY RESPONSE

Objective: By May 21 (within 1 week of the May 14 vote), deliver the finalized room-by-room schedule for all 12 Waldron spaces to programming staff, so the 2027–28 season can be built ahead of the June 1 public announcement.

EXCHANGE 29**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

This objective creates a measurable post-vote handoff: one finalized schedule covering all 12 spaces, delivered by May 21 before the June 1 announcement.

Progress: Your Gate 4 draft contains exactly one goal and three measurable objectives. Every objective includes numbers or dates, May 14 is a fixed point, and none extends beyond June 1.

Next: Would you like formal evaluation now? If so, say *Submit Gate 4*.

MY RESPONSE

Submit Gate 4.

EXCHANGE 30**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Gate: 4 — Goals & Objectives

Progress: 5 of 5 required items passed. Your work contains exactly one goal and three objectives. Every objective includes measurable numbers or dates, May 14 is used as a fixed point, and all completion dates occur before June 1.

What still needs attention: Nothing blocking.

Ready to move on: YES — Gate OPEN

Optional advice: This advice does not block you. The May 14 objective depends on the board approving the plan, an outcome Marcus cannot control; later refinement could distinguish preparing an approval-ready plan from the board's independent decision.

Connection to your earlier work: The 385-hour community-access gap, \$35,000 planning budget, and ongoing scheduling framework connect to your earlier requirements and Big 5 work. The approval dependency is the one authority tension noted above.

Your next move: Say *Begin Gate 5* when you are ready to start Scope of Work.

MY RESPONSE

Begin Gate 5.

Gate 5 - Scope of Work

EXCHANGE 31

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Gate 5: Scope of Work

This gate defines what the project will produce, what stays outside it, and how work moves toward approval and handoff. We'll build the project statement first, then boundaries, constraints and assumptions, deliverables, and the Scope Action Plan. Deliverables are things handed over—not activities.

What you will produce:

- Project statement with five exact labels
- Five fixed exclusions in a separate Exclusions section
- Separately labeled constraints and assumptions
- Action-plan lines beginning with action verbs
- Deliverables with named approvers
- Deliverables landing on at least two dates

Progress: Gates 1–4 are preserved; Gate 5 drafting has begun.

Next: For the project statement's trigger section, what event or condition makes this project necessary now?

MY RESPONSE

Trigger: Eighteen months after the merger closed, no decision on shared space use has been made, and the 2027–28 season cannot be planned until it is — combined with Meridian falling short of its lease-required community-access hours (515 of 900). Dana Okoye's directive assigning Marcus to lead the process, against the fixed calendar (kickoff January 12, board vote May 14, public season announcement June 1), makes resolving allocation necessary now rather than later.

EXCHANGE 32**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

You've connected the unresolved post-merger allocation, community-access gap, Dana's directive, and fixed board and season deadlines into a clear reason for acting now.

The project statement requires the exact lowercase label trigger.

Progress: The trigger content is preserved.

Next: Rename only the heading to trigger, keeping your wording unchanged.

MY RESPONSE

trigger: Eighteen months after the merger closed, no decision on shared space use has been made, and the 2027–28 season cannot be planned until it is — combined with Meridian falling short of its lease-required community-access hours (515 of 900). Dana Okoye's directive assigning Marcus to lead the process, against the fixed calendar (kickoff January 12, board vote May 14, public season announcement June 1), makes resolving allocation necessary now rather than later.

EXCHANGE 33**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

The heading now matches the required label, and the trigger is preserved.

Progress: The trigger component is complete.

Next: For the project statement's action component, what will the project actually do to address that trigger? Use the exact lowercase label action.

MY RESPONSE

action: Develop and evaluate space-allocation options for all Waldron spaces using the 2019 utilization study and stakeholder input from the three legacy program leads, Tomas, and Priya; produce a recommended allocation plan that closes the community-access gap and respects all existing contractual and safety constraints; and bring it through the Facilities Committee to a board vote.

EXCHANGE 34**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your action describes analysis, consultation, option development, recommendation, and governance review without adding construction or lease changes.

Progress: The trigger and action components are complete and preserved.

Next: Draft frequency and timing: when does the work occur, what recurring activities are involved, and which fixed checkpoints shape it? Use that exact lowercase label.

MY RESPONSE

frequency and timing: A one-time project running roughly seventeen weeks, from kickoff on January 12 to handoff by May 21, with recurring biweekly (or similar regular-cadence) working sessions among Marcus, Priya, and Tomas, and ongoing consultation with the three legacy leads throughout. Fixed checkpoints anchor the work: the Board Facilities Committee progress update on March 19, the full board vote on May 14, and the finalized schedule handed to programming by May 21, ahead of the public season announcement on June 1.

EXCHANGE 35**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

You've established the project window, recurring team and consultation cadence, and all major checkpoints through the programming handoff.

Progress: trigger, action, and frequency and timing are complete and preserved.

Next: Draft the exact scope component: what spaces, planning work, and outputs are included within this project? Avoid adding any fixed exclusions.

MY RESPONSE

scope: This project covers the allocation of all Waldron spaces — the Ruth Auditorium, Firebay black box, Main Gallery, Corridor Gallery, Studios A–F, the shared scene shop, and the admin suite's nine desks — among the three legacy programs and existing outside users. It includes reviewing the 2019 space utilization study and booking data, consulting the three legacy artistic leads and outside tenants, evaluating allocation options against the community-access, contractual, and safety requirements, and producing a recommended room-by-room schedule and a plan to close the 385-hour community-access gap, for Facilities Committee review and board approval.

EXCHANGE 36**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your scope identifies the physical areas, planning activities, affected users, requirement checks, and the room-by-room and community-access outputs.

Progress: Four project-statement components are complete and preserved.

Next: Draft constraints and uncertainty: identify the fixed limits the project must obey and the important facts or decisions that remain uncertain. Use that exact lowercase label.

MY RESPONSE

constraints and uncertainty:

Constraints: the \$35,000 facilities-planning budget covers no capital work and no staff time; the team has only 0.75 FTE combined capacity; the dance school holds Studios C/D through August 2028; the Main Gallery calendar is contracted 14 months out; fire-code occupancy and ADA rules apply with no capital fix available; and the calendar is fixed (March 19, May 14, June 1).

Uncertainty: whether and how the three legacy artistic leads will participate is undecided (Dana controls this and hasn't announced anything to staff); no one has been assigned to handle fallout from an unhappy legacy lead or to communicate with the City; Marcus's authority to lead exists only in an email, not a formal or announced mandate; and exact room-level occupancy/ADA compliance details still need verification.

EXCHANGE 37

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

You've separated fixed constraints from unresolved participation, authority, communication, and room-level verification questions. All five exact project-statement labels are now present.

Progress: The complete project statement is preserved.

Next: Add a separately labeled **Exclusions** section by carrying forward the five fixed IDs and meanings from Gate 3 unchanged. Keep them as five distinct entries.

MY RESPONSE

Exclusions:

1. **EX-01_CAPITAL_WORK — No renovation, construction, or capital campaign.** The project works only within the existing physical building.
2. **EX-02_STAFF_RESTRUCTURING — No staff restructuring or layoffs.** Personnel structure is not part of this allocation decision.
3. **EX-03_TICKETING_MERGE — No merging the three legacy ticketing systems.** Ticketing integration is a separate, unaddressed effort.
4. **EX-04_LEASE_RENEGOTIATION — No renegotiating the City lease.** Lease terms (including the 900-hour requirement) are fixed inputs, not negotiable within this project.
5. **EX-05_SEASON_SELECTION — No choosing the 2027–28 season's shows.** Programming content decisions belong to programming staff, not this allocation process.

EXCHANGE 38

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

The separate **Exclusions** section preserves all five fixed IDs and meanings exactly.

Progress: The project statement and exclusions are complete and preserved.

Next: Add a separately labeled **Constraints** section containing the fixed limits that govern the work. You may carry forward the constraints already identified without rewriting the rest of your project statement.

MY RESPONSE

Constraints:

1. \$35,000 total facilities-planning budget — covers a facilitator, printing, room-scheduling software, and outside participant stipends; covers no staff time.
2. No capital funds — no renovation, wall moves, or equipment purchases.
3. Team capacity limited to 0.75 FTE combined (Marcus 0.4, Priya 0.2, Tomas 0.15), each also carrying other full duties.
4. Dance school's Studios C/D reservation (Tue/Thu, 4–8 p.m.) runs through August 2028.

5. Main Gallery exhibition calendar is contracted 14 months out.
6. City lease requires 900 hours/year of community access at below-market rates.
7. Fire-code occupancy limits and ADA access requirements apply throughout, with no capital funds available to address gaps.
8. Fixed calendar: kickoff January 12, Board Facilities Committee update March 19, full board vote May 14, public season announcement June 1.

EXCHANGE 39

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Your Constraints section clearly separates budget, capacity, contractual, lease, safety, and calendar limits.

Progress: The project statement, exclusions, and constraints are complete and preserved.

Next: Add a separately labeled Assumptions section. What does the plan currently rely on that is plausible but not confirmed or guaranteed? Include only assumptions, not fixed scenario facts.

MY RESPONSE

Assumptions:

1. The three legacy artistic leads will participate in the process even though their involvement is Dana's call and hasn't been formally decided or announced.
2. The 2019 space utilization study's booking data still reasonably reflects current usage patterns, despite being several years old and predating the merger.
3. The six community groups without written agreements will be willing to adjust to a new schedule if asked.
4. The \$35,000 budget is sufficient to cover a facilitator, scheduling software, printing, and stipends without exceeding cost.
5. Gwen Tsai and the City will accept Meridian's plan to close the community-access gap without requiring additional concessions.
6. Dana will back Marcus's authority and decisions if a legacy lead pushes back, even though she has said she won't referee disputes directly.

EXCHANGE 40

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Your assumptions are explicitly uncertain and cover participation, data currency, community-group flexibility, budget sufficiency, City acceptance, and executive backing.

Progress: The project statement, exclusions, constraints, and assumptions are complete and preserved. Deliverables are next.

A deliverable is a tangible item someone receives and approves, not the activity used to create it.

Next: What tangible deliverable will be handed over for the March 19 checkpoint, and who is its named approver? Include its delivery date.

MY RESPONSE

Deliverable: A draft allocation options report — covering proposed room-by-room use for all 12 Waldron spaces and a documented plan to close the community-access gap (515 □ 900 hours) — delivered March 19.

Approver: Ruth Adeyemi, Board Facilities Committee chair.

EXCHANGE 41

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

That is a tangible report with defined coverage, a delivery date, and a named approver.

Progress: The March 19 draft allocation options report is preserved as the first deliverable.

Next: What tangible deliverable should reach the May 14 board decision, and who is its named approver? Include its delivery date.

MY RESPONSE

Deliverable: A final recommended Waldron allocation plan — the complete room-by-room schedule for all 12 spaces, the community-access compliance plan, and confirmation it fits within the \$35,000 budget — delivered May 14.

Approver: The Meridian Board of Directors (full board vote).

EXCHANGE 42**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

The May 14 item is a tangible final plan, and the full board is the decision authority identified in the scenario. Your deliverables already land on two distinct dates.

Progress: The March 19 options report and May 14 final allocation plan are preserved.

Next: What tangible post-vote deliverable will programming receive before June 1, on what date, and who will approve it?

MY RESPONSE

Deliverable: A finalized room-by-room space schedule for all 12 Waldron spaces (translating the board-approved allocation plan into operational detail programming can build around) — delivered May 21.

Approver: Dana Okoye, Executive Director, confirming it matches the board-approved plan before programming staff begin building the 2027–28 season calendar for the June 1 announcement.

EXCHANGE 43**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your May 21 schedule is a tangible operational handoff with a named approver and a clear relationship to the board-approved plan.

Progress: Three deliverables are preserved across March 19, May 14, and May 21, each with a named approver.

The Scope Action Plan should account for the work promised in your project statement. Use this structure: **action verb + work performed + intended output or checkpoint.**

Next: Draft the Scope Action Plan as concise lines, beginning every line with an action verb.

MY RESPONSE**Scope Action Plan:**

1. Retrieve and analyze the 2019 space utilization study and its booking data to establish a baseline of actual room usage.
2. Consult the three legacy artistic leads, Priya, and Tomas to document each program's space needs and constraints.
3. Identify the gap between current (515 hrs) and required (900 hrs) community-access hours and evaluate options to close it.
4. Develop two to three draft allocation options that satisfy all confirmed requirements (lease, contracts, safety) within the \$35,000 budget.

5. Present the draft options and community-access gap plan to the Board Facilities Committee by March 19.
6. Incorporate committee feedback and refine the allocation options into a single recommended plan.
7. Submit the final recommended allocation plan to the Board of Directors for a vote by May 14.
8. Translate the board-approved plan into a finalized room-by-room operational schedule.
9. Deliver the finalized schedule to programming staff and Dana Okoye by May 21, ahead of the June 1 season announcement.

EXCHANGE 44**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Every Scope Action Plan line begins with an action verb and carries the work from evidence gathering through consultation, option development, governance review, final scheduling, and handoff.

Progress: Your Gate 5 draft now includes the five-part project statement, separate exclusions, constraints and assumptions, three tangible deliverables with named approvers across three dates, and a complete action plan.

Next: Would you like formal evaluation now? If so, say `Submit Gate 5`.

MY RESPONSE

`Submit Gate 5`.

EXCHANGE 45**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Gate: 5 — Scope of Work

Progress: 7 of 7 required items passed. Your project statement contains all five exact labels. The separate `Exclusions` section preserves all five fixed IDs and meanings. Constraints and assumptions are separately labeled, every action-plan line begins with an action verb, and all three deliverables are tangible outputs with named approvers across March 19, May 14, and May 21.

What still needs attention: Nothing blocking.

Ready to move on: YES — Gate OPEN

Optional advice: This advice does not block you. Before the final audit, add the consequence if each important assumption proves false and identify who will perform the next validation check.

Connection to your earlier work: Your scope carries forward the community-access gap, existing commitments, authority boundaries, May 14 decision point, and May 21 programming handoff. The five exclusions remain consistent with Gate 3.

Your next move: Say `Begin Gate 6` when you are ready to build the Work Breakdown Structure.

MY RESPONSE

`Begin Gate 6`.

Gate 6 - Work Breakdown Structure and Final Audit

EXCHANGE 46**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Gate 6: Work Breakdown Structure

A WBS decomposes approved scope into hierarchical work packages; it is not a chronological schedule. Each package must be specific enough to assign, estimate, and trace to a Gate 5 deliverable or explicit

project-management/pre-planning branch. After the WBS is assembled, we'll complete the internal final audit before formal evaluation.

What you will produce:

- All three Gate 5 deliverables represented
- Unique hierarchical IDs with valid parent links
- Exactly one owner per work package
- Time window and positive people-hours per package
- Complete resource details for every package
- Resource summary with pre-vote effort at or below 525 hours

Progress: Gates 1–5 are preserved; Gate 6 drafting has begun.

Next: What top-level WBS branches and unique IDs will organize the three deliverables and pre-planning work?

MY RESPONSE

Top-level WBS branches:

- **1.0 Project Management & Pre-Planning** — kickoff, patron alignment, scope/charter documentation, ongoing coordination.
- **2.0 Data Gathering & Stakeholder Consultation** — 2019 study review, legacy lead/Priya/Tomas consultation, community-access gap analysis (feeds all three deliverables).
- **3.0 Draft Allocation Options Report (March 19 deliverable)**
- **4.0 Final Allocation Plan & Board Vote (May 14 deliverable)**
- **5.0 Programming Handoff Schedule (May 21 deliverable)**

EXCHANGE 47

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Your structure gives each Gate 5 deliverable a dedicated branch and creates explicit places for pre-planning and shared evidence work.

For every work package, include:

ID | parent ID | package description | linked branch/deliverable | owner | time_window | people_hours | facilitator_days | software_tools | equipment | materials | contractors | outside_participants

Use exactly one owner—Marcus, Priya, or Tomas. Use PRE_VOTE or POST_VOTE, positive numeric hours, numeric zero for unused facilitator days, and NONE for every other unused resource field.

Progress: Top-level branches 1.0–5.0 are preserved.

Next: Decompose branch 1.0 Project Management & Pre-Planning into specific work packages using every field above.

MY RESPONSE

Branch 1.0 Project Management & Pre-Planning — Work Packages:

ID	Parent	Description	Linked Branch/Deliverable	Owner	Time Window	People-Hours	Facilitator Days	Software/Tools	Equipment	Materials	Contractors	Outside Participants
1.1	1.0	Confirm mandate and scope boundaries with Dana Okoye (patron alignment)	1.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	4	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
1.2	1.0	Draft the project charter components (Big 5, requirements, expectations, goals/objectives, scope statement)	1.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	18	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
1.3	1.0	Run ongoing project coordination and status check-ins with Priya and Tomas	1.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	12	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
1.4	1.0	Prepare briefing materials for the March 19 Facilities Committee update	3.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	6	0	NONE	NONE	printed handouts	NONE	NONE

EXCHANGE 48**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Branch 1.0 has valid parent links, one permitted owner per package, pre-vote timing, positive hours, and complete resource entries. Package 1.2 also satisfies the required pre-planning coverage.

Progress: Branches 1.0–5.0 and work packages 1.1–1.4 are preserved. Current pre-vote effort: 40 people-hours.

Next: Decompose 2.0 Data Gathering & Stakeholder Consultation using the same fields, including specific packages for the existing study, consultation, and community-access analysis.

MY RESPONSE

Branch 2.0 Data Gathering & Stakeholder Consultation — Work Packages:

ID	Parent	Description	Linked Branch/Deliverable	Owner	Time Window	People-Hours	Facilitator Days	Software/Tools	Equipment	Materials	Contractors	Outside Participants
2.1	2.0	Retrieve and review the 2019 space utilization study (floor plans, dimensions, booking data)	2.0	Tomas	PRE_VOTE	8	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
2.2	2.0	Consult the three legacy artistic leads on space needs and the Firebay conflict	2.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	12	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	three legacy artistic leads
2.3	2.0	Consult outside tenants (dance school, community groups, gallery artists) on existing commitments	2.0	Priya	PRE_VOTE	8	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	dance school rep, community group reps
2.4	2.0	Analyze the community-access hours gap (515 vs. 900) and identify options to close it	3.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	10	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
2.5	2.0	Compile stakeholder input and booking data into a consolidated baseline usage summary	3.0	Tomas	PRE_VOTE	6	0	room-scheduling software	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE

EXCHANGE 49**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Branch 2.0 has valid hierarchy, permitted single owners, complete resource entries, and specific evidence and consultation work. It links the baseline and gap analysis into the March 19 deliverable.

Progress: Branches 1.0 and 2.0 are preserved. Current pre-vote effort: 84 people-hours.

Next: Decompose 3.0 Draft Allocation Options Report into work packages that produce and deliver the March 19 report, using the same complete field set.

MY RESPONSE

Branch 3.0 Draft Allocation Options Report (March 19) — Work Packages:

ID	Parent	Description	Linked Branch/Deliverable	Owner	Time Window	People-Hours	Facilitator Days	Software/Tools	Equipment	Materials	Contractors	Outside Participants
3.1	3.0	Facilitate an options-development workshop with Marcus, Priya, and Tomas to generate 2-3 allocation options	3.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	9	1	NONE	NONE	NONE	local facilitator	NONE
3.2	3.0	Draft the options report narrative and room-by-room comparisons against requirements	3.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	14	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
3.3	3.0	Review the draft report with Priya and Tomas for accuracy	3.0	Tomas	PRE_VOTE	4	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
3.4	3.0	Finalize, print, and deliver the report to the Facilities Committee by March 19	3.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	4	0	NONE	NONE	printing	NONE	NONE

EXCHANGE 50

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Branch 3.0 decomposes option generation, drafting, internal review, and delivery of the March 19 report. All packages have valid IDs, owners, timing, hours, and complete resource entries.

Progress: Branches 1.0–3.0 are preserved. Current pre-vote effort: 115 people-hours and 1 facilitator day.

Next: Decompose 4.0 Final Allocation Plan & Board Vote into work packages that produce and submit the May 14 deliverable, using the same fields.

MY RESPONSE

Branch 4.0 Final Allocation Plan & Board Vote (May 14) — Work Packages:

ID	Parent	Description	Linked Branch/Deliverable	Owner	Time Window	People-Hours	Facilitator Days	Software/Tools	Equipment	Materials	Contractors	Outside Participants
4.1	4.0	Incorporate March 19 Facilities Committee feedback into a refined allocation option	4.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	8	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
4.2	4.0	Re-consult the three legacy artistic leads on the refined single recommended option	4.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	8	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	three legacy artistic leads
4.3	4.0	Verify the final plan meets community-access, budget, contractual, and safety requirements	4.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	6	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
4.4	4.0	Prepare the board packet and presentation materials for the May 14 vote	4.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	8	0	NONE	NONE	printed board packet	NONE	NONE
4.5	4.0	Present the final allocation plan to the Board of Directors for vote on May 14	4.0	Marcus	PRE_VOTE	3	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE

EXCHANGE 51**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Branch 4.0 carries committee feedback through refinement, consultation, requirement checks, board materials, and the May 14 presentation. Its hierarchy and resource fields are complete.

Progress: Branches 1.0–4.0 are preserved. Current pre-vote effort: 148 people-hours and 1 facilitator day.

Next: Decompose 5.0 Programming Handoff Schedule into POST_VOTE work packages that produce and deliver the May 21 schedule, using positive hours and the same complete resource fields.

MY RESPONSE

Branch 5.0 Programming Handoff Schedule (May 21) — Work Packages:

ID	Parent	Description	Linked Branch/Deliverable	Owner	Time Window	People-Hours	Facilitator Days	Software/Tools	Equipment	Materials	Contractors	Outside Participants
5.1	5.0	Translate the board-approved allocation plan into a detailed room-by-room operational schedule	5.0	Marcus	POST_VOTE	8	0	room-scheduling software	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
5.2	5.0	Review the draft schedule with Tomas for production and tech-week feasibility	5.0	Tomas	POST_VOTE	4	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
5.3	5.0	Obtain Dana Okoye's approval confirming the schedule matches the board-approved plan	5.0	Marcus	POST_VOTE	2	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE
5.4	5.0	Deliver the finalized schedule to programming staff by May 21	5.0	Marcus	POST_VOTE	2	0	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE	NONE

EXCHANGE 52

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Branch 5.0 completes the May 21 deliverable through post-vote scheduling, feasibility review, approval, and handoff. Every Gate 5 deliverable now appears in the WBS.

Progress: The full WBS is assembled. Pre-vote and post-vote work remain separated, and all packages contain the required ownership, hours, and resource fields.

Next: Draft the project resource summary by totaling PRE_VOTE, POST_VOTE, and overall people-hours; totaling facilitator days; summarizing software, equipment, materials, contractors, and outside participants; and identifying which non-staff categories could draw on the \$35,000 planning budget. Detailed dollar estimates are not needed.

MY RESPONSE

Project Resource Summary

- **PRE_VOTE people-hours:** 148 (Branch 1.0: 40, Branch 2.0: 44, Branch 3.0: 31, Branch 4.0: 33) — within the 525-hour pre-vote cap.
- **POST_VOTE people-hours:** 16 (Branch 5.0).
- **Total people-hours:** 164.
- **Facilitator days:** 1 total (Package 3.1, options-development workshop).
- **Software/tools:** Room-scheduling software (Packages 2.5, 5.1).
- **Equipment:** None used across the WBS.
- **Materials:** Printed handouts (1.4), report printing (3.4), printed board packet (4.4).
- **Contractors:** One local facilitator engagement (3.1).
- **Outside participants:** The three legacy artistic leads (2.2, 4.2); dance school and community group representatives (2.3).

Budget-eligible categories (draw on the \$35,000 facilities-planning budget): the facilitator day (local rate \$1,200/day), room-scheduling software, printing/materials, and any stipends for outside participants (dance school/community group reps). Staff people-hours (Marcus, Priya, Tomas) are not chargeable to this budget, since it explicitly excludes staff time.

EXCHANGE 53

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Your resource summary reconciles all categories, keeps staff time outside the planning budget, and confirms 148 pre-vote hours—well below the 525-hour ceiling.

Progress: The WBS and resource summary are complete. The remaining work is the internal Assumption / Scope-Creep Audit and Revision within Gate 6.

Begin with Assumption audit:. For each material Gate 5 assumption, provide:

assumption | source or status | consequence if false | validation owner | next check

Do not mark an assumption confirmed without scenario evidence or a named authority; otherwise use VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY.

Next: Draft the Assumption audit: for your six Gate 5 assumptions.

MY RESPONSE

Assumption audit:

1. **Assumption:** The three legacy artistic leads will participate in the process.

Source/status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY — participation is Dana's call and has not been confirmed or announced.

Consequence if false: Options are built without key input, risking late rework or leads contesting the plan after it's drafted.

Validation owner: Dana Okoye.

Next check: At kickoff (January 12), confirm Dana has formally communicated the participation expectation to all three leads.

2. **Assumption:** The 2019 study's booking data still reflects current usage patterns.

Source/status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY — the study predates the merger and has never been cross-checked.

Consequence if false: Allocation options are based on stale patterns and misfit current program demand.

Validation owner: Tomas Beltrán (longest building tenure).

Next check: During package 2.1/2.5, cross-check the study's data against Tomas's current knowledge and recent bookings before drafting options.

3. **Assumption:** The six unwritten community groups will accept schedule adjustments.

Source/status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY — no written agreements exist to confirm flexibility.

Consequence if false: Community-access hours or goodwill could drop if groups leave rather than adjust.

Validation owner: Priya Raghavan (package 2.3 owner).

Next check: During stakeholder consultation (2.3), before the March 19 report is finalized.

4. **Assumption:** The \$35,000 budget is sufficient for the planned facilitator, software, and materials.

Source/status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY — costs haven't been itemized/quoted yet.

Consequence if false: Facilitator days, software, or stipends may need to be cut mid-project.

Validation owner: Marcus Feld.

Next check: Obtain facilitator and software quotes before scheduling the 3.1 workshop.

5. **Assumption:** Gwen Tsai/the City will accept Meridian's community-access gap-closure approach.

Source/status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY — Gwen controls audit strictness and hasn't been consulted.

Consequence if false: The board-approved plan could still fail lease compliance after the fact.

Validation owner: Marcus Feld.

Next check: Share the draft gap-closure approach with Gwen Tsai before the May 14 board vote.

6. **Assumption:** Dana will back Marcus's authority if a legacy lead pushes back.

Source/status: VERIFY WITH THE APPROPRIATE AUTHORITY — his mandate exists only in an email and is untested.

Consequence if false: Marcus lacks leverage to resolve conflict, risking the stall pattern seen in the abandoned donor-database project.

Validation owner: Dana Okoye.

Next check: Secure written, staff-announced confirmation of Marcus's mandate at kickoff.

EXCHANGE 54

AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION

Your assumption audit covers all six assumptions with appropriate verification status, consequences, owners, and time-bounded checks.

Progress: The Assumption audit: component is complete and preserved.

Next: Draft Scope-creep comparison: by comparing the approved Gate 5 scope and deliverables against the WBS. Identify anything added, removed, expanded, narrowed, or contradicted. If you find no change, state that only after explaining what you compared.

MY RESPONSE**Scope-creep comparison:**

I compared the Gate 5 project statement (scope, constraints, exclusions, assumptions), the three approved deliverables (March 19 options report, May 14 final plan, May 21 handoff schedule), and the nine-line Scope Action Plan against the full WBS (branches 1.0–5.0, packages 1.1–5.4).

Deliverables: all three Gate 5 deliverables appear in the WBS exactly as approved — no deliverable was added, dropped, merged, or redefined.

Scope: every WBS package traces back to either a Gate 5 action-plan line (study review, stakeholder consultation, gap analysis, option development, drafting, board submission, handoff) or the explicit pre-planning/PM branch. Nothing in the WBS touches the five excluded areas (capital work, restructuring, ticketing merge, lease renegotiation, season selection) — the exclusions remain intact.

Constraints: the 148 pre-vote hours stay within team capacity, the one facilitator day and materials/software costs fit the budget-eligible categories, and package dates align with the fixed calendar (March 19, May 14, May 21) — no constraint was loosened or ignored.

Minor elaborations, not scope changes: three packages add operational detail not spelled out line-by-line in the Gate 5 action plan — 1.4 (committee briefing logistics), 4.2 (re-consulting legacy leads on the refined option), and 5.2 (Tomas's feasibility review of the handoff schedule). These are reasonable decomposition of already-approved action-plan steps (refinement, delivery, handoff), not new work, new deliverables, or expanded scope.

Having compared deliverables, scope boundaries, exclusions, constraints, and the action plan against every WBS branch, I find no scope creep, contradiction, or unapproved expansion — the WBS operationalizes Gate 5 without changing it.

EXCHANGE 55**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your comparison checks the deliverables, scope boundaries, exclusions, constraints, action plan, and every WBS branch. It also distinguishes ordinary decomposition detail from expanded scope.

Because your conclusion is no change, the audit requires the exact fixed statement.

Progress: The Scope-creep comparison: is complete and preserved.

Next: Add Disposition: NO SCOPE CHANGE DETECTED, followed by one brief student-written reason based on your comparison.

MY RESPONSE**Disposition: NO SCOPE CHANGE DETECTED**

The WBS only breaks the approved Gate 5 scope into more detailed work packages; it does not add, remove, or expand any deliverables, exclusions, or project boundaries.

EXCHANGE 56**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

The disposition now uses the exact no-change statement and includes your explanation that added detail is decomposition rather than expanded scope.

Progress: The assumption audit, scope-creep comparison, and disposition are complete and preserved.

Next: Draft Final revision record: stating whether Gate 5 or the WBS requires revision after this audit, and explain why. If no revision is needed, record a justified NO CHANGE conclusion.

MY RESPONSE**Final revision record: NO CHANGE**

Neither Gate 5 nor the WBS requires revision because the audit found no scope creep or contradictions; the WBS remains aligned with the approved scope, deliverables, exclusions, constraints, and project boundaries.

EXCHANGE 57**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your final revision record clearly states the no-change result and ties it to the completed alignment review.

Progress: Four final-audit components are complete and preserved. One remains.

Next: Draft *Why this is defensible*: connecting your no-change conclusion to the requirements, expectations, objectives, constraints, and available team capacity. Use your own reasoning.

MY RESPONSE

Why this is defensible: The no-change conclusion is defensible because the WBS supports the established requirements, stakeholder expectations, and project objectives while respecting the \$35,000 budget, fixed deadlines, exclusions, and the team's limited 0.75 FTE capacity.

EXCHANGE 58**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Your final explanation connects the no-change conclusion to the requirements, expectations, objectives, budget, deadlines, exclusions, and team capacity.

Progress: The complete WBS, resource summary, assumption audit, scope-creep comparison, disposition, final revision record, and defensibility explanation are preserved.

Next: Would you like formal evaluation of Gate 6 now? If so, say *Submit Gate 6*.

MY RESPONSE

Submit Gate 6.

EXCHANGE 59**AGENT'S RESPONSE / QUESTION**

Gate: 6 — Work Breakdown Structure

Progress: 14 of 14 applicable required items passed, including the internal final audit. All three Gate 5 deliverables appear in the WBS. Work packages have valid hierarchical IDs, single permitted owners, time windows, positive hours, and complete resource details. Pre-vote effort totals 148 hours against the 525-hour ceiling. Your audit contains all five components and supports the no-change conclusion.

What still needs attention: Nothing blocking.

Ready to move on: YES — Gate OPEN

Optional advice: This advice does not block you. Package 2.3 names gallery artists in its work description but omits them from its outside-participants field; aligning those details would improve resource planning.

Connection to your earlier work: Every Gate 5 deliverable is traceable through the WBS. The requirements, expectations, objectives, exclusions, constraints, assumptions, and capacity remain consistent, with no accepted or exchanged scope change requiring reconciliation.

Your next move: Local Test 2 is complete; no additional gate is required.

Because this was a local test with Actions and telemetry prohibited, no backend logging or final-report issuance occurred.

Final Completion Summary

- Check-in completed for Local Test 2 with no Actions or telemetry.
- Gate 1 - Big 5 Pre-Planning: completed and opened.
- Gate 2 - Requirements: completed and opened.
- Gate 3 - Expectations / MoSCoW: completed and opened.
- Gate 4 - Goals & Objectives: completed and opened.
- Gate 5 - Scope of Work: completed and opened.
- Gate 6 - Work Breakdown Structure: completed and opened.
- Internal Gate 6 assumption and scope-creep audit: completed with NO SCOPE CHANGE DETECTED and a final NO CHANGE revision record.
- Local Test 2 concluded without backend logging or final-report issuance, consistent with the no-Actions/no-telemetry instruction.